

MIWAE Framework and Coursebook Fit Rubric



Printable handout for Pragmatic Considerations for Authors and Publishers on Modification of Input in Written Academic English

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github.com/MehmetDEU/MIWAE

Purpose: MIWAE supports transparent comparison of EMI textbooks for multilingual readers. It connects reader needs with observable textual choices and checks whether those choices appear where they are needed.

Status: This is a provisional coursebook fit review instrument rather than a validated universal scale. Apply it to matched samples and document every judgement.

How to read the framework

Layer	Question answered	Required record
Function	What reader need does the feature address?	Select one of the seven dimensions and state the local purpose.
Form	Which observable textual, visual or numerical device supplies the function?	Record the feature and its page or segment location.
Distribution	How reliably is the form available across eligible points of need?	Define eligible opportunities before counting coverage, timing and spread.
Reader evidence	Do students notice, use or still need the support?	Keep student perceptions separate from textbook counts, then interpret them together.

Seven review dimensions

Dimension	Review question	Observable forms	Distribution indicators
1 Access to disciplinary meanings	Are key terms unpacked where first needed?	Definition, gloss, adjacent paraphrase, worked example	First use coverage, proximity to the term, recurrence when meaning shifts
2 Orientation and navigation	Can readers see where the explanation is going?	Preview, roadmap, heading, recap, cross reference	Coverage at openings and transitions, chapter spread, consistency
3 Rhetorical relations and importance	Are claims, contrasts, causes and qualifications visible?	Relation marker, scope cue, importance cue	Coverage of eligible relations, placement, dispersion across modes
4 Background knowledge	Is required but potentially non shared context made accessible?	Context note, analogy, familiar label, local reference gloss	Coverage at assumed knowledge points, timing, purposeful repetition
5 Conceptual continuity	Are prerequisites reactivated where later explanations depend on them?	Recall cue, bridge, restatement, backward or forward reference	Coverage at conceptual dependencies, distance from prior content, recurrence
6 Reader engagement and self monitoring	Can readers check or monitor understanding at the learning point?	Question, self check, pause prompt, worked reasoning	Density per section, placement after learning point, feedback availability
7 Multimodal support	Do prose, visuals and notation explain one another?	Label, caption, figure reference, worked graph, aligned notation	Coverage of visual opportunities, co location with prose, cross chapter consistency

Coursebook fit rubric dimensions 1 to 4

Rate matched sample locations rather than impressions of the whole book. Set each dimension as essential, supporting or not applicable before inspection.

Dimension and review question	0 Unsupported	1 Limited	2 Adequate	3 Systematic
1 Meaning access Are key terms unpacked where first needed?	No explanation or a misleading explanation	A gloss appears late, rarely or without context	An accurate local explanation appears at main points of need	Terms, examples and references remain consistently aligned
2 Orientation Can readers see where the explanation is going?	Structure and purpose remain opaque	Headings exist, but transitions remain weak	Useful previews, recaps and cross references guide main sections	Orientation recurs at major conceptual transitions
3 Rhetorical relations Are claims, contrasts and qualifications visible?	Relations are obscured or incorrectly signalled	Some markers appear, with important gaps	Main relations and conditions are explicit	Relations remain explicit across prose, examples and visuals
4 Background knowledge Is required context made accessible?	Essential context is silently assumed	Context appears after readers need it	Concise context or analogy appears at need	Context is calibrated and revisited without overload

Recording distribution

Coverage uses a defined denominator: supported opportunities divided by eligible opportunities in the matched sample. Also record timing and spread. For example, note whether support appears at first mention, arrives later, and occurs across several chapters rather than in one isolated passage.

Perceived distribution reports how many participants mention a need or support. Keep this measure separate from the textbook count.

Coursebook fit rubric dimensions 5 to 7

Dimension and review question	0 Unsupported	1 Limited	2 Adequate	3 Systematic
5 Conceptual continuity Are prerequisites reactivated at dependence?	Earlier concepts are silently assumed	Connections are distant or inconsistent	Bridges and recall cues appear at key dependencies	Connections build a visible cumulative knowledge path
6 Reader engagement Can readers check or monitor understanding?	No usable route for checking understanding	Prompts are generic or detached	Questions and checks match the learning point	Checks recur with feedback or worked reasoning
7 Multimodal support Do prose, visuals and notation explain one another?	Modes conflict or essential labels are missing	Visuals exist, but links remain weak	Labels and references support interpretation	Modes are deliberately sequenced and mutually explanatory

Mandatory gates

Gate	Question
Disciplinary accuracy	Does the explanation preserve accurate disciplinary meaning?
Precision preserved	Does support clarify the material without removing necessary technical distinctions?
No native speaker deficit assumption	Does the judgement focus on communicative access and course fit rather than imitation of a native norm?
Disciplinary fit	Does the book support the course's epistemic and multimodal practices?

Evidence tags and decision rule

Tag	Evidence basis	Decision	Rule
T	Text only: feature, page and denominator	Choose	Every essential dimension scores at least 2 and every gate passes.
TP	Text plus student perception	Choose and supplement	One essential dimension scores 1 and an explicit supplement can cover the gap.
TPC	Text, perception and comprehension evidence	Reconsider	An essential dimension scores 0, placement repeatedly fails, or an accuracy gate fails.

Conceptual basis: Council of Europe (2020); Bjorkman (2013); Seidlhofer (2011); Mauranen, Hynninen and Ranta (2016); Jenkins and Mauranen (2019); McKinley (2025). MIWAE operationalises these orientations for coursebook review.

Six step review procedure

Step	Action	Record
1	Profile the course and readers	English level, year, prior knowledge and reading tasks
2	Set priorities before inspecting books	Mark every dimension as essential, supporting or not applicable
3	Sample the same locations in every candidate	Include openings, term introductions, transitions, complex examples and chapter closes
4	Code function, form and distribution	Record the device, eligible opportunity, timing and chapter spread
5	Rate support and tag the evidence	Apply the 0 to 3 rubric and add T, TP or TPC
6	Choose, supplement or reconsider	Apply the decision rule and state any required teaching support

Coursebook evaluation sheet

Coursebook and edition			Course and discipline		
Intended readers			Sample locations		
Dimension	Priority E S N A	Rating 0 to 3	Tag T TP TPC	Page or sample evidence	Supplement or decision note
1 Meaning access					
2 Orientation					
3 Rhetorical relations					
4 Background knowledge					
5 Conceptual continuity					
6 Reader engagement					
7 Multimodal support					

Final decision: Choose / Choose and supplement / Reconsider

Reason and required action: _____